



V.K. DATTA



**“** Prevention involves intelligence and pre-emptive strikes on terror modules before they can strike.

**After 26/11, it was for the first time that India was actually able to prove to the world that Pakistan is a rogue nation.**

If you don't have the response mechanism properly organised, there will be a time lag in dealing with terror attacks.

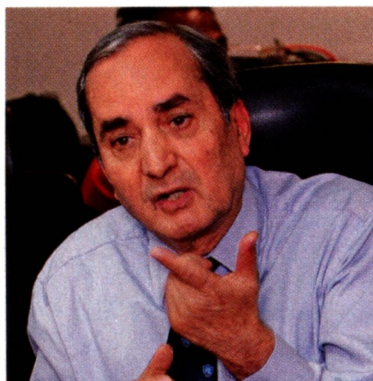
**Training IPS officers will take long as there is no equipment and finances are limited.**

**Can 26/11 happen again? Yes, at any time as we have not improved our preventive capabilities.** **”**

KAPIL KAK

**“** Nothing has happened in India as Pakistan is pre-occupied with the troubles on its western borders.

**Situational awareness in managing terror now and in the next 10 or 15 years is crucial for any mechanism to succeed.**



**Unless India gets a Homeland Security kind of a template, nothing much can be done.**

**We have precision attack capabilities, but we need to factor into our calculus that Pakistan is not going to let that attack or series of attacks go uncontested.**

**It was a statesman-like act in not exercising the military option post-26/11.** **”**

tive assessments. I have not come across a single objective police assessment on police performance and their impact on us. The real intelligence, tackling of terror is actually done by the footsoldiers. I don't think that Chidambaram has reached the footsoldiers. Chidambaram has only reached the Central Police Organisations (CPOs). He has at least met the Intelligence Bureau (IB) chief and the NSA, but why didn't he meet the state DGPs? The BSF and CRPF should be a part of his meeting and he should start involving others CPOs.

I don't think the responses are truly corrective, they are still only reactive. I want to see Chidambaram grooming leadership. I doubt if he is doing it. I don't see impatience in him. We all have to be in a hurry to be good leaders. If Chidambaram says police is a state subject, it is not acceptable to me because he can groom leadership. Maybe our expectations from him are high.

There is a big difference in the way we are responding to this meeting and the last one; the last one was one of total helplessness. Today, we may be over the moon but we should not be satisfied. We expect Chidambaram to spread good practices, structures, systems, responses and human resource policies down the line.

*Ajai Sahni, Executive Director, Centre for Conflict Studies:* I agree with Kiran. There is a tremendous change in ambience but it is essentially something on the surface. Basically, our expectations are too high. Our standards have fallen so low that we are delighted with anybody doing anything. India is the only country in the world which idolises people for doing their jobs. What has been done in terms of real capacity transformation? Yes, there has been some additional efficiency in utilisation of existing capacities. In certain sectors, intelligence is one of the critical areas, the Central agencies have also been geared up to start trying to coordinate with the state agencies.

Are we better prepared? Chidambaram's answer was "we are as vulnerable as we were on 26/11". It